

Land Selection Framework

What we're building

A bioregioning tool for communities seeking to belong to a place and help it flourish over 50–100 years. The premise: where a community settles is too important to leave to gut-feel and real-estate listings. Climate trajectory, soil resilience, water security, geopolitical sovereignty, the density of existing regenerative networks: these decide whether a project survives its first generation. But they sit scattered across hundreds of public datasets, in incompatible formats, and are almost impossible to combine without serious effort.

The output is a transparent, open-source, open-data framework and demonstration that surfaces these dimensions in one place, with full source / vintage / method transparency, and no hidden scoring that pretends one place is better than another. The user decides what matters; the tool shows the data honestly.

Reciprocity is the spine. A place is not empty. Every region in the demonstration carries a *Land standing* entry: whose land this already is (the Indigenous nation and the treaty or unceded status in North America, the rooted community or commons in Europe), how land is held, how to arrive in good faith, and what arriving asks of the people already there. It is qualitative only: never scored, never ranked, never a filter. Land standing entries are assembled from public sources and checked against opened pages; no nation or community named in them has reviewed them.

What the framework refuses to be. It filters; it never scores, ranks, or tells you where to go. It does not forecast whether a community will thrive, it does not give legal advice, and it does not stand in for the relationship that arriving in a place begins. Where arriving in a place would harm the community already there, the honest answer is not to go.

V1 is data ingestion: clean, documented public datasets exportable to Jupyter and QGIS. No search interface, no scoring. **V2** adds a query and weighting layer, and red-line filtering for hard disqualifiers. **V3** extends to on-site data (soil kits, sensors, walking observations) and cosmological data governance. V1 is what's being worked on now. A designed demonstration of the framework runs alongside it at <https://land-selection-framework.regencommunity.tools>; it shows threshold filters (filter, never score) over sourced and dated values. It is a demonstration, not a finished data product, and the group has not yet ratified the slate or the V1 proposal.

Currently r4 (delivered). The r4 to r5 handoff is open to any member of the group; “How collaboration works” below explains what that means.

How collaboration works

The project is structured as a **passed-around document package**. Three markdown files — Overview, Specifications, Implementation Strategy — travel together as a single versioned plan. They are the source of truth. Everything else (this doc, chat threads, the original criteria sheet in Drive) is derivative.

Two counters track state:

- **vN — implementation version**. Currently v1. Increments when the scope of what we're building changes substantially.
- **rN — collaboration round**. Currently r4 (delivered); the r4 to r5 handoff is open to any member. Increments each time the documents are passed to a new contributor.

Each round works like this:

1. A contributor receives the package along with a **Handoff Request** — a short note describing what's being asked of them in this round.
2. They read the documents with an AI assistant guiding the session.
3. They contribute their perspective — revising sections, adding commentary, answering open questions, surfacing what their experience sees that isn't there.
4. Decisions already tagged **[COMMITTED]** are not overwritten — commentary is added below them, attributed.
5. They update the **Collaboration Log**: one row in the Contribution History table with their name, role, and what they added.
6. They prepare the next Handoff Request (open, or directed to a specific person).
7. The documents pass on.

Why this shape. It keeps the documents coherent (one editor at a time), preserves attribution, and makes the project's evolution legible. Anyone reading the Collaboration Log can see how each idea got there and who put it there.

Parallel work is welcome. The document protocol covers formal contributions to the docs themselves. Plenty of useful work happens off the rounds — practitioner interviews, framework reading, data-source scouting, dataset access checks — and folds into a future round. Nobody needs to wait their turn to start contributing.

Sync points run alongside the rounds. The Implementation Strategy defines five moments where the whole group weighs in rather than a single contributor: locking the criteria list, locking the data-source priority list, locking V1 scope after the coverage report, declaring V1 shipped, and the V1 → V2 transition. These are group decisions, not individual ones.

Where we are right now. r3 was Deca's synthesis on 28 April. r4 was delivered on 2026-05-29 by Gustaf, who holds the practitioner seat, with an addendum on reciprocity and host-community

standing on 2026-10-05. The handoff to r5 is open to any member of the group, in no prescribed order, and the next contributor has not yet been chosen.

What's in the docs (rounds so far)

- **r1 — Adam** sketched the GIS architecture and named several non-negotiables that the project keeps: no hidden composite scores, every value carries source and vintage, the interface must never imply more precision than the underlying data has.
- **r2 — Askja**, who originated the framework, wrote its substance: twelve metrics covering geopolitical resilience, climate, regenerative networks, water, ecology, energy autonomy, accessibility, biodiversity, economic and legal context. Named data sources for most of them, introduced the **state + trajectory** scoring model, and the **red lines** concept for absolute disqualifiers.
- **r3 — Deca** synthesised both into a coherent V1 plan with framing decisions and reasoning, a clean scope (V1 = data ingestion only; no querying or scoring), and an 11-step implementation sequence. Documented the V2/V3 design questions where Adam and Askja's framings disagree, so neither is lost.
- **r4 — Gustaf**, holding the practitioner seat, delivered a field reality-check grounded in a working demonstration build, folded into a V1 production run (twelve ingested Tier-1 layers). An addendum on 2026-10-05 raised a finding the framing had not seen: all four of the sovereignty axes describe the incoming settlers' sovereignty, and none describes the standing of those already rooted in a place. It proposes host-community standing as a fifth consideration, qualitative only. The addendum is a proposal; the group has not ratified it.

The three documents that travel together are `Overview.md` (framing), `Specifications.md` (what V1 produces), and `Implementation Strategy.md` (sequencing). The portable statement of the framework discipline, `FRAMEWORK.md`, sits beside them as a proposal and is not part of the package.

Working group

Person	Role	Status
Adam	GIS architect	Contributed r1
Askja	Framework originator, regenerative land practitioner	Contributed r2
Deca	Synthesiser	Contributed r3
Gustaf	Practitioner reality-check, embedded in eco-villages	Contributed r4 (practitioner seat)
Monty	Regenerative academic research	Named contributor, not yet engaged

Person	Role	Status
Alaska	Data engineering	Named contributor, not yet engaged

The “named contributor” rows reflect the Expected Contributors table in the Overview — people the package is meant to reach but who haven’t yet had their round.

Possible roles to take

These are categories of contribution, not formal positions. Anyone can hold more than one, and the list is descriptive — propose a role that isn’t here if it fits what you’d bring.

- **Practitioner.** You’ve gone through the process of looking for a place yourself, or with others, and have field-tested knowledge of what actually mattered. Reality-checks on the framework, stories, friction points the docs don’t see. The work now includes reading whose land a place is and what arriving asks of the people already there.
- **Researcher.** Depth in one of the dimensions — climate projection, soil resilience, civilizational stability, geopolitical risk, ecological recovery, agroecology. You keep the framework from being naive in your area. The work now includes reading whose land a place is: treaty and tenure history, customary regimes, and what the people already there say about arrival.
- **Cartographer.** GIS, spatial data, the craft of making landscapes legible. Architecture, data formats, map design.
- **Scout.** Frameworks, datasets, sources others miss. Obscure papers, regional registries, maintained open-data portals.
- **Interviewer.** 30-minute conversations with land-seekers, capturing patterns. High-leverage: brings the field’s lived experience into the framework without requiring practitioners to read markdown.
- **Storyteller.** Articulates the project in language that travels. Keeps the why intact as the work gets technical.
- **Bridge-builder.** Sits between this and other regenerative networks, funders, partners, allied projects. Locates the work in the wider field, finds collaborators.
- **Steward.** Holds rhythm and continuity. Keeps the group moving, the documents alive, contributions from getting lost between sessions.
- **Builder.** When V1 ingestion needs pipeline code written, you write it. Probably not the first hands needed.

How to plug in

1. Read the three documents (Overview.md , Specifications.md , Implementation Strategy.md — ~45 min total).
2. Name the role(s) you’d take.

3. Coordinate with the current active contributor about taking a future round, or starting parallel work that feeds in. There is no public contact route yet; the working group will set one.

The pace is async. Contributions can be single-round or sustained. Stepping back after one round is normal — the protocol is designed for asymmetric participation.

Project state

Open-source, open-data, low-cost, non-commercial. Working group, not an organisation. The documents are the structure; everything else is conversation around them.